



variably trained in ballet and gymnastics at school, which allows them to pull off the flips, turns and somersaults that are fast becoming part of Bollywood. Depending on their training, they get a minimum of Rs 10,000 for a day, with travel, food and rent taken care of. Black dancers are paid more, because they are more exotic.

As the demand grows, agencies have automatically been divided according to geographical areas of operation. Delhi-based Ashish Mullick's company works mostly with Russian dancers while the Icelandic agency, Eskimo, launched in India in 2005, provides Scandinavian talent for modelling and Bollywood. Says Enakshi Chakraborty, 43, CEO, Eskimo India, "Bollywood trends are changing. Films

BANKING ON DANCE

■ Samba, Cancan and hip-hop are much in demand at corporate events. Dancers get between Rs 15,000 and Rs 20,000 for a performance.

■ Belly dance and Bollywood moves remain the popular choices at weddings.

■ Bollywood spectacles are the order of the day at private parties with acts like ribbon-and-ring, capoeira (an Afro-Brazilian martial art), juggling crystal balls and fire branding.

■ Now Bollywood songs include acts with synchronised swimmers, acrobats, gymnasts and circus troupes. Each dancer is paid between Rs 35,000 and Rs 40,000 for a performance.

are seeking a universal platform. If the subject is international, it will work anywhere." Which is why Icelandic beauty Sigríður Hrönn Guðmundsdóttir aka Sigga, 25, got to hang on to Amitabh Bachchan's arm in *Kabhi Alvida Na Kehna* and shake her booty in a Sandeep Chowta music video.

Much like Bollywood, corporate events and parties too have become playgrounds for theme-based performances, from samba dancers and flamenco performers to belly dancers and flame-twirling damsels. Piyush Soni of Corporate Events (India) says, "Clients are increasingly asking to see different cultures. Just as abroad there is a big demand for Bollywood parties, simi-